

SuperStore Sales Analysis

Business Requirements & Analytical Questions — Project Brief

PRIMARY TOOLS	DATASET	PREPARED BY	DOC TYPE
Power Query · Pivot Tables · Dashboard	SuperStoreOrders.csv	Prabhat Kumar	Business Requirements

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Executive Summary

Management needs a clear view of revenue, profitability, customer behaviour, and operational performance across markets, regions, categories, and time. This project converts transactional data into decision-ready insights using Microsoft Excel.

Business Objectives

- Identify top-performing categories, regions and markets.
- Understand profit and loss drivers.
- Evaluate customer segment and market contribution.
- Measure delivery and shipping performance.
- Analyze monthly, quarterly and yearly trends.
- Assess the effect of discounting on profitability.
- Compare weekday and weekend purchasing behaviour.

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Stakeholders

CEO	Sales Manager	Regional Manager	Product Manager	Operations Manager	Supply Chain	Finance	Marketing
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Purpose: define decision-oriented requirements before building the analysis and dashboard.

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Approved Business Requirements

● Sales Performance ● Profitability ● Customer & Market ● Operations ● Product Performance

SALES PERFORMANCE — 5 requirements

ID	Business Question	Business Purpose	Analytical Output
BR-01	Which product category generates the highest sales revenue?	Identify revenue-driving categories.	Category → Sum of Sales
BR-02	Which region generates the highest sales?	Compare geographical performance.	Region → Sum of Sales
BR-03	Which market contributes the highest revenue?	Identify strongest markets.	Market → Sum of Sales
BR-05	Which are the Top 5 countries by sales?	Support regional planning.	Country → Top-5 Sales
BR-16	How do Weekend and Weekday sales compare?	Support promotions and staffing.	Day Type → Sum of Sales

PROFITABILITY — 9 requirements

ID	Business Question	Business Purpose	Analytical Output
BR-06	Which category generates the highest and lowest profit?	Identify profitable and weak categories.	Category → Sum of Profit
BR-08	Which region generates the highest profit and the highest loss?	Identify regions requiring attention.	Region → Sum of Profit
BR-09	Which products are generating the highest losses?	Identify products needing review.	Product → Bottom-10 Profit
BR-10	Does discount reduce profitability?	Assess discount impact on profit.	Discount vs Profit — Scatter
BR-11	Which sub-category generates the highest profit?	Identify high-performing lines.	Sub-Category → Sum of Profit
BR-12	Which customer segment generates the highest profit?	Support retention priorities.	Segment → Sum of Profit
BR-13	Which market has the highest profit margin?	Compare market efficiency.	Market → Profit Margin %
BR-17	How does profit margin vary across quarters?	Identify seasonal profitability.	Quarter → Profit Margin %
BR-21	How does profit margin vary across Sales Ranges?	Analyze profitability by transaction size.	Sales Range → Margin %

CUSTOMER & MARKET — 2 requirements

ID	Business Question	Business Purpose	Analytical Output
BR-04	Which segment contributes the highest sales and profit?	Identify the most valuable segment.	Segment → Sales + Profit
BR-07	Which categories receive the highest average discount?	Review discount strategy.	Category → Avg Discount

OPERATIONS — 2 requirements

ID	Business Question	Business Purpose	Analytical Output
BR-14	What is the average delivery time?	Measure delivery efficiency.	Delivery Days → Average
BR-15	Which shipping mode is used most frequently?	Understand shipping demand.	Ship Mode → Order Count

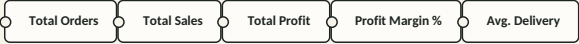
PRODUCT PERFORMANCE — 3 requirements

ID	Business Question	Business Purpose	Analytical Output
BR-18	Which product is sold the most?	Identify best sellers.	Product → Top-10 Quantity
BR-19	Which product is sold the least?	Identify slow-moving products.	Product → Bottom-10 Quantity
BR-20	Which products perform best across categories and regions?	Optimize product assortment.	Category + Region → Matrix

A dashboard should answer decisions — not simply display charts.

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Executive KPI Framework



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Power Query Preparation Scope

- Validate data types, duplicates and missing values.
- Validate delivery days and unusual values.
- Create Delivery Days, Month Name, Quarter and Year.
- Create Profit Margin % with Sales = 0 handling.
- Create Sales Range and Profit Status.
- Create Day Type: Weekday / Weekend.

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Business Analyst Thinking Framework

- 1 Who is asking the question?
- 2 Why do they need the answer?
- 3 Which metric and dimension answer it?
- 4 What decision could change after seeing the result?
- 5 What action or recommendation could follow?

Example: "Does discount reduce profitability?" is stronger than "What is the average discount?" — the first can influence pricing, promotions and margin protection.

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Expected Business Outcomes

- Improve product portfolio decisions.
- Increase and protect profitability.
- Optimize discount strategy.
- Identify growth markets and regions.
- Improve logistics performance.
- Understand customer purchasing behaviour.
- Support evidence-based management decisions.

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Project Deliverables

- Power Query cleaned dataset
- Documented feature engineering
- Pivot Table analysis mapped to requirements
- Interactive Excel dashboard with KPIs, charts and slicers
- Key insights and business recommendations
- GitHub-ready documentation and LinkedIn project summary